

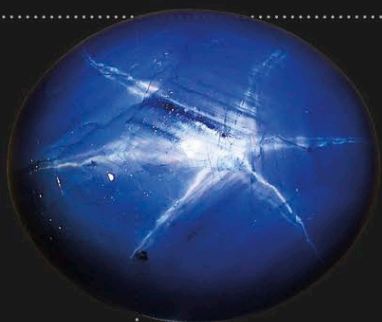
Record-breakers

Big, beautiful, and near-perfect – these are the qualities that characterize most of the world's record-breaking gems. Some are kept in the vaults of royal collections or distinguished museums, while others are recent finds fresh from the Earth. Here is a selection of the gems that have set new records for size or quality, both new discoveries and established treasures.



Sweet Josephine

When it sold for \$28.5 million in 2015, the 16.08-carat, cushion-cut Sweet Josephine gemstone set a record-breaking price for pink diamonds.



Star of Adam

This gem, the world's largest blue star sapphire, was found in 2015 in Ratnapura, Sri Lanka.



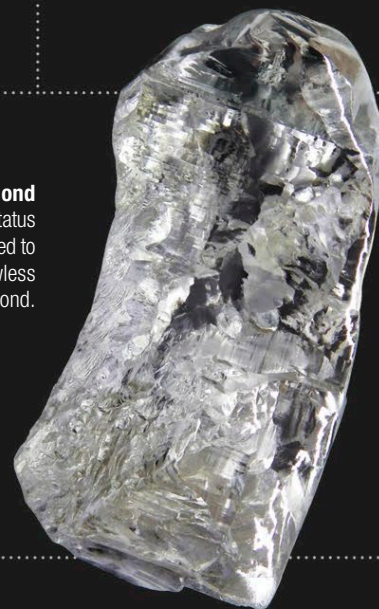
Gachala emerald

One of the largest uncut emeralds in the world, the Gachala weighs 858 carats.



De Beers diamond

This yellow diamond formed the centrepiece of the Patiala Necklace (see pp.90–91).



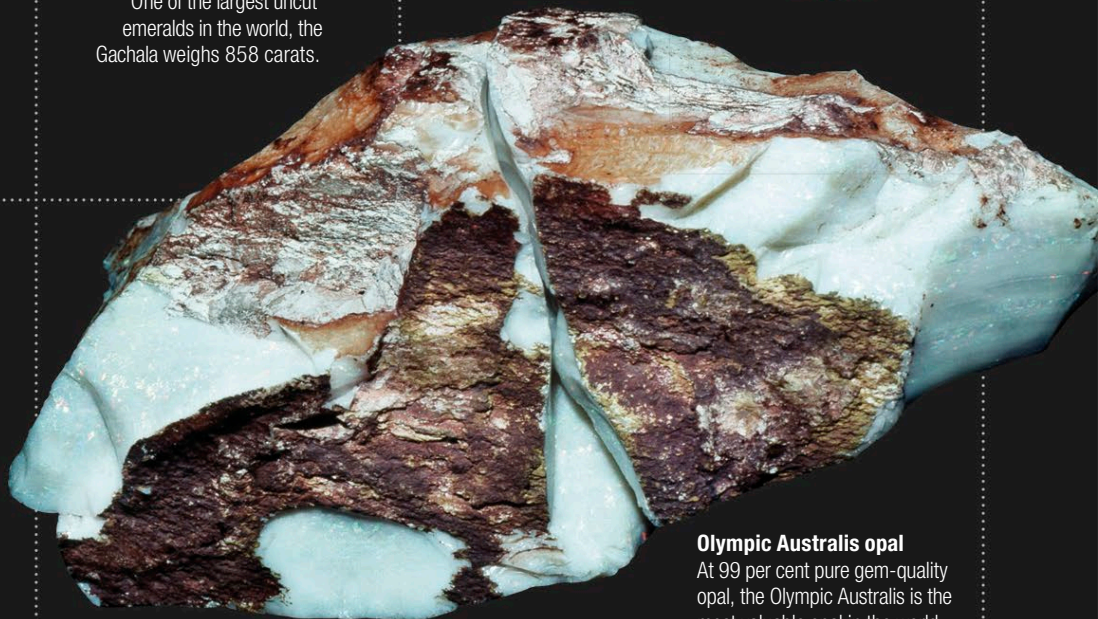
Lucapa diamond

The rare Type IIa status was awarded to this almost flawless rough diamond.



Carmen Lucia ruby

This 23.1-carat Burmese ruby has uniquely fine colour and clarity.



Olympic Australis opal

At 99 per cent pure gem-quality opal, the Olympic Australis is the most valuable opal in the world.